

Install the Plain Writing skill in Claude

This skill makes Claude write plainly and strip the patterns that make text read as AI-generated. It is a single Markdown file with no scripts, so you can open it and read every line before you install it.

Before you start

You need a Claude account with Code execution and file creation turned on. Custom skills do not work without it. Open Settings, go to Capabilities, and switch on Code execution and file creation. If your Settings has no Skills section at all, your plan or region may not have the feature yet.

Install from the ZIP (quickest)

1. Download plain-writing.zip. Do not unzip it.
2. In Claude, open Settings and find the Skills section. Depending on your version it sits under Customize or Features.
3. Click the plus button, then Create skill, then choose the upload option.
4. Select plain-writing.zip.
5. When the skill appears in your list, toggle it on.

Or paste it in by hand

1. Open SKILL.md and copy the whole file.
2. In Claude, go to Settings, then Skills, then the plus button, then Create skill.
3. Paste the contents into the new skill and save.

Check it works

Start a new conversation and ask Claude to draft something short, a post or an email. The skill loads on its own whenever writing is involved, because that is what its description tells Claude to do, so you do not have to name it. To switch it off, toggle it in the Skills list.

Notes

- A custom skill you upload is private to your own account.
- The skill is descriptive, not a word ban. It flags patterns; it does not blindly delete words.
- The catalogue of AI tells is adapted from the Wikipedia editors' field guide, Signs of AI writing (WP:AISIGNS):
https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Wikipedia:Signs_of_AI_writing
- Official install reference, Claude Help Center, Use skills in Claude:
<https://support.claude.com/en/articles/12512180-use-skills-in-claude>

